

REBUILDING INTIMACY

A Workbook for Couples Reconnecting

By Daniel Tesfamariam

WHAT IS INTIMACY?

Intimacy is much more than physical connection.

TRUE INTIMACY HAS 5 DIMENSIONS:

- Emotional:** Sharing feelings, being vulnerable, feeling understood
- Physical:** Touch, affection, sexual connection
- Intellectual:** Sharing ideas, learning together, stimulating conversation
- Spiritual:** Shared values, meaning-making, purpose together
- Experiential:** Shared adventures, creating memories, trying new things

Which dimension needs the most attention in your relationship?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

INTIMACY ASSESSMENT

Both partners rate each area 1-10 (1=disconnected, 10=deeply connected):

AREA	P1	P2	Gap
Emotional safety/vulnerability	—	—	—
Physical affection (non-sexual touch)	—	—	—
Sexual satisfaction	—	—	—
Intellectual stimulation	—	—	—
Spiritual connection	—	—	—
Fun & adventure together	—	—	—
Communication quality	—	—	—
Trust level	—	—	—
Feeling prioritized	—	—	—
Overall relationship satisfaction	—	—	—

Biggest gap to address first:

COMMUNICATING ABOUT DESIRES

Use these sentence starters to express needs safely:

- 'I feel most connected to you when...'
- 'Something I'd love more of is...'
- 'I feel disconnected when...'
- 'A way you could help me feel safe is...'
- 'Something I've been wanting to try...'
- 'What I need right now is...'

PARTNER 1 - My desires & needs:

PARTNER 2 - My desires & needs:

BARRIERS TO INTIMACY

Common barriers (check all that apply to your relationship):

- ☐ Unresolved conflict/resentment
- ☐ Stress (work, finances, parenting)
- ☐ Past trauma (individual or relational)
- ☐ Trust broken (infidelity, lies)
- ☐ Different desire levels
- ☐ Body image issues
- ☐ Poor communication
- ☐ Lack of time/energy
- ☐ Emotional walls/avoidance
- ☐ Feeling like roommates not partners

Our #1 barrier right now:

One step we can take to address it:

36 QUESTIONS - PART 1

What would constitute a perfect day for you?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

When did you last sing to yourself? To someone else?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

If you could change anything about how you were raised, what?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

Share something you consider a positive quality of your partner.

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

What do you value most in a friendship?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

36 QUESTIONS - PART 2

What is your most treasured memory?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

What is your most terrible memory?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

What roles do love and affection play in your life?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

Share an embarrassing moment in your life.

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

When did you last cry? In front of another person? Alone?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

VULNERABILITY PROMPTS

Something I've been afraid to tell you...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

I feel most loved when you...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

A fear I have about our relationship...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

Something I admire about you that I don't say enough...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

The hardest thing about being vulnerable with you...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

DEEPER CONNECTION

How have I hurt you that I haven't fully acknowledged?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

What do you need from me that you're not getting?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

What dream have you given up that I could support?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

When do you feel most alone in our relationship?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

What would make you feel completely safe with me?

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

GRATITUDE & APPRECIATION

Three things I'm grateful you do that I overlook...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

A moment this week when I felt proud of you...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

How you've helped me grow as a person...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

What I love about our life together...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

A quality you have that first attracted me to you...

Partner 1: _____

Partner 2: _____

NON-SEXUAL TOUCH RECONNECTION

Rebuild physical connection WITHOUT the pressure of sex:

- ☐ Hold hands while watching TV
- ☐ 6-second kiss goodbye (not a peck!)
- ☐ 20-second hug daily
- ☐ Massage each other's hands/feet
- ☐ Sit close, touching, while talking
- ☐ Dance together in the kitchen
- ☐ Play with each other's hair
- ☐ Walk arm in arm
- ☐ Cuddle for 10 minutes before sleep
- ☐ Touch their arm when talking

This week we will try:

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 1

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 2

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 3

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 4

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 5

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 6

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 7

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

WEEKLY CONNECTION - WEEK 8

What was the best part of your week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

What stressed you most this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

When did you feel most connected to me?

P1: _____

P2: _____

Is there anything you need from me this week?

P1: _____

P2: _____

One thing I appreciate about you this week:

P1: _____

P2: _____

Date night idea: _____

Touch goal: _____

LOVE MAPS UPDATE

How well do you know your partner? (Gottman Love Maps)

Partner's biggest current worry:

My answer: _____

Correct answer: _____

Partner's favorite way to relax:

My answer: _____

Correct answer: _____

Partner's best friend right now:

My answer: _____

Correct answer: _____

Partner's current dream/goal:

My answer: _____

Correct answer: _____

Partner's favorite meal:

My answer: _____

Correct answer: _____

What stresses partner most at work:

My answer: _____

Correct answer: _____

Partner's love language:

My answer: _____

Correct answer: _____

OUR INTIMACY GOALS TOGETHER

Together, we commit to:

Our emotional intimacy goal:

Our physical intimacy goal:

Our communication goal:

Our weekly ritual:

Our date night frequency:

What we'll do when we feel disconnected:

Signed:

Partner 1: _____ Date: _____

Partner 2: _____ Date: _____

